

WORLD GOTHIC ATLAS

Promotion & Production Playbook

Editing Presets • Location Prompts • Captions & Lore • Organic Promotion • Analytics • Roadmap

Product: Gothic Cappadocia — Surreal Realism Digital Art Collection

Store: worldgothicatlas.gumroad.com/l/upcnu

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1. Brand Editing Presets

Goal: every piece — Cappadocia or Japan — reads as the same visual world. Apply these as a base pass, then hand-tune per image.

Lightroom — “MYTHIC-DARK” Base Preset

Panel	Setting	Value	Why
Basic	Exposure	-0.3 to -0.5	Slightly underexposed reads as moodier, more intentional
Basic	Contrast	+25	Cinematic punch without crushing midtones
Basic	Highlights	-40	Protects sky/moon detail from blowing out
Basic	Shadows	-15	Keeps shadows deep rather than lifted/flat
Basic	Whites	-10	Softens harsh peak brightness
Basic	Blacks	-30 to -35	Crushed blacks = gothic depth
Basic	Texture	+15	Enhances stone/wood/rock grain
Basic	Clarity	+20	Adds painterly mid-contrast bite
Basic	Dehaze	-20 to -30	Negative dehaze ADDS atmospheric fog
Basic	Vibrance / Saturation	-10 / -5	Slight desaturation keeps the palette moody, not cartoonish
Color Grading	Shadows	Hue ~220-230° (blue-teal), Sat 20-25	Cold shadow cast
Color Grading	Highlights	Hue ~20-30° (warm amber/crimson), Sat 10-15	Warm lantern-glow highlights
Color Grading	Blend / Balance	Blend -50, Balance toward shadows	Keeps the cold/warm split cinematic, not muddy
Detail	Sharpening / Masking	40 / 30	Sharpens edges only, not fog/sky
Effects	Vignette	Amount -25, Midpoint 50, Feather 60	Draws the eye inward
Effects	Grain	Amount 15-20, Size 25, Roughness 50	Re-art print texture, kills digital flatness

Luminar Neo — “MYTHIC-DARK” AI Pass

Tool	Setting	Notes
Develop	Exposure / Contrast / Highlights / Shadows / Whites / Blacks	-0.3 / +25 / -40 / -15 / -10 / -30 (mirrors Lightroom Basic panel)
Atmosphere AI	Add Fog, density 30-40%	Set fog height to cover the lower third of the frame for depth
Structure AI	+30	Increases texture on rock, stone, bark surfaces
Color Harmony	Shadows: deep blue (#1a2942) / Highlights: crimson (#a8324d)	Locks in the cold/warm split
Dramatic / Dark Contrast	Amount 40%	Cinematic contrast boost, apply after color grade
Sunrays (if moon visible)	Intensity ~20%	Subtle moonlight glow, do not overdo
Radial / Luminosity Mask	Golden Hour tool, low intensity, masked to windows	Used only to warm lantern/window light sources, not the whole frame
Vignette	-25	Match Lightroom vignette

Tool	Setting	Notes
Grain	15%	Match Lightroom grain

2. Move 2: Japanese Haunted Locations

Real photography → gothic-surrealist edit, following the same pipeline as the Cappadocia collection.

1. Mount Osore (Osorezan), Aomori — “Gateway to the Underworld”

A real photograph of Mount Osore's volcanic wasteland transformed into a painterly gothic-surrealist composition: thousands of stone Jizo statues wrapped in tattered red cloth line a sulfur-scarred plain, steam vents glowing faintly beneath a swollen blood-orange moon, deep crimson-blue color grading, dense atmospheric fog rolling across cracked white-yellow earth, cinematic chiaroscuro lighting, hyper-detailed photoreal textures, fine-art realism holding up at large print size, mood: sacred dread.

A — style-intensified: Same scene, statues in tighter foreground, fog thicker, crimson intensified beyond natural saturation, single blood-orange moon dominating the sky.

B — atmosphere-shifted: Same scene at midnight during thin rain, statues slick and reflective, distant lightning silhouettes a torii gate, fog lit from within by hidden lantern glow, palette shifts colder — deep indigo and ash with one warm ember-red source.

C — cross-culture fusion: Fuse Mount Osore's Jizo wasteland with Cappadocia's carved rock-spire silhouettes in the background — statues foreground, jagged fog-wrapped stone towers behind, bridging both collections.

2. Okunoin Cemetery, Koyasan — “The Lantern Path”

Real photography of Okunoin's cedar-forest cemetery reimaged gothic-surrealist: ancient moss-armored tombstones lean at odd angles beneath towering black cedars, hundreds of stone lanterns glow amber through low fog, a sliver of moonlight cuts through the canopy, deep shadow falloff, cinematic color grade (cool green-blue ambient, warm lantern highlights), painterly detail on moss and stone texture, ultra-atmospheric, print-ready fine art.

3. Gunkanjima (Hashima Island) — “The Drowned Fortress”

Real photograph of Hashima Island's ruined concrete tower blocks transformed into gothic-industrial surrealism: crumbling apartment facades rise like a dead citadel from a storm-grey sea, broken windows glow faintly orange as if still inhabited, dense fog and sea-spray atmosphere, desaturated palette with rust-crimson accents, dramatic low-angle composition emphasizing scale and decay, hyper-detailed weathered concrete texture.

4. Aokigahara Forest, Mt. Fuji — “The Sea of Trees”

Real forest photography reworked gothic-surrealist: dense root-tangled trees form a claustrophobic canopy, thick ground fog swallows the forest floor, a single shaft of pale moonlight pierces the canopy onto a moss-covered boulder, deep near-black shadow with cold blue-grey ambient light, oppressive silence conveyed through tight framing, painterly texture on bark and fog.

5. Fushimi Inari (upper trails) — “The Endless Gate”

Real photograph of the vermilion torii tunnel transformed: gates recede into thick fog and darkness, faint red lantern glow bleeding through the mist, moss creeping up weathered wood, a lone silhouette figure faces away mid-tunnel for scale, crimson-and-black palette intensified beyond natural saturation, cinematic vanishing-point composition, fine-art realism.

6. Himeji Castle — “Okiku's Watch”

Real castle photography reimagined: Himeji's white tiered towers loom under a heavy blood-moon sky, a well in the foreground courtyard glows faintly from within (Okiku's well), fog pooling at the base of the walls, dramatic uplighting on castle stonework, moody blue-crimson grade, gothic-fortress silhouette emphasized against the moon.

7. Inunaki Village Ruins, Fukuoka — “The Village That Forgot Itself”

Real ruin photography transformed gothic-surrealist: collapsed wooden houses overtaken by vines and moss, a single window still lit with warm firelight amid total decay, dense fog rolling through the empty village path, cold desaturated exterior against one warm interior glow, painterly weathered-wood texture.

8. Shirakawa-go under snow, night — “The Steep Roof Hollow”

Real village photography under snow, night: steep thatched gassho-zukuri roofs loom like dark peaks against a full moon, snow glowing pale blue, one house window lit amber, smoke curling from a chimney, fog low across the snow, muted cold-blue palette with a single warm focal point, folk-horror stillness.

3. Gumroad Captions & Lore Lines

Move 1 — Gothic Cappadocia (live product)

Product title: “Gothic Cappadocia — Surreal Realism Digital Art Collection”

Product description (Gumroad): Step into a darker Cappadocia. This collection reimagines the surreal rock formations of Cappadocia, Turkey through a gothic, dreamlike lens — moody skies, dramatic light, and hyper-detailed photoreal textures that blur the line between reality and fantasy. Each image is a hand-edited composition built from real Cappadocia photography, transformed with a painterly gothic-surrealist treatment: deep shadows, atmospheric fog, cinematic color grading, and fine-art realism that holds up at large print sizes.

Lore lines (per image — use as captions/alt text/social hooks):

Clifftop Moonlit Citadel: *“Where the sky forgets to end, the citadel remembers.”*

Firelit Rock Spire Dwelling: *“Every hollow needs a hearth.”*

Moonlit Stone Passage: *“Some stairs lead down. These lead elsewhere.”*

Move 2 — Haunted Japan (upcoming product)

Suggested product title: “Haunted Japan — Surreal Gothic Digital Art Collection”

Suggested product description (Gumroad): Step into a Japan the maps don't show. This collection reimagines Japan's most haunted and atmospheric real places — volcanic underworlds, lantern-lit cemeteries, drowned fortresses — through a gothic, dreamlike lens. Each image is hand-edited from real photography into a painterly gothic-surrealist composition: deep shadow, dense fog, cinematic color grading, and fine-art realism built to hold up at large print sizes.

Suggested tags: gothic, dark fantasy, digital art, japan, haunted, wall art, surreal, fine art print

Lore lines (per location — pick 3 for the first Japan drop):

Mount Osore: *“The gate does not close. It only waits for you to notice it's open.”*

Okunoin Cemetery: *“The lanterns have burned for a thousand years. They are not for the living.”*

Gunkanjima: *“The sea kept the walls standing. It did not keep anything else.”*

Aokigahara Forest: *“The trees remember every name spoken beneath them.”*

Fushimi Inari (upper trails): *“Each gate is a promise. Not all of them are kept.”*

Himeji Castle: *“The well still counts. It has never reached ten.”*

Inunaki Village: *“The village did not die. It simply stopped answering.”*

Shirakawa-go (snow, night): *“Under that roofline, something is still awake.”*

Social caption template (reusable): [Lore line] — [Location name], reimagined. Part of the World Gothic Atlas. ■ Full collection → link in bio. #darkfantasyart #gothicart #digitalart #dreamcore #worldbuilding

4. Organic Promotion Tactics — X & TikTok

No paid ads. Targets: Japan, USA, Germany, England — via timing + language/hashtag rotation on one account per platform.

Posting-Time System

Slot	Time (UTC)	Local hits
A — X morning	13:00	UK 2pm / DE 3pm / US 9am ET / JP 10pm
B — X evening	00:00	US 8pm ET / JP 9am / UK 1am (catches up by morning)
C — TikTok	18:00	US 2pm ET / UK 7pm / DE 8pm — JP catches it via FYP later

Regional Caption Rotation

Tue & Fri: add German line + #gotik #dunklefantasie #digitalekunst. Thu & Sun: add Japanese line + #■■■■■
#■■■■■■■■■■ #■■■■■■■■■■. Mon/Wed/Sat: English-only, US/UK-leaning cultural references (gothic literature, folklore nods).

Content Pillars

- Before/After transformation (real photo → gothic edit) — best performer on TikTok
- Slow cinematic pans across a piece with moody ambient audio
- Lore snippets — one world-building line per post
- “Which realm would you enter?” polls/carousels
- Mockups — art framed/displayed as a poster in a dark room

Selling Tactics on Gumroad Itself

- Add tags to every product (gothic, dark fantasy, digital art, wall art, [location]) to feed Gumroad Discover/search — free organic traffic.
- Ask early buyers directly for a review — replaces the “be the first to review” fallback with social proof.
- Pin the Gumroad link at the top of the X profile; put it in the TikTok bio.
- Consider Gumroad Affiliates later — performance-based, still zero ad spend.

5. Analytics & TikTok Pixel Arrangement

Why a TikTok Pixel Doesn't Belong on the Gumroad Landing Page

The custom Gumroad landing page runs inside a sandboxed iframe with restricted network access. A real TikTok Pixel needs to load a script from TikTok's servers and send tracking beacons back — exactly the kind of cross-origin call the sandbox blocks. Pasting pixel code into landing.html will very likely not fire. It also wouldn't help yet: pixel data is used to optimize **paid** ad delivery and build retargeting audiences — with no ad spend running, there is nothing for it to feed.

Primary Tracking System (works today, free)

Use UTM-tagged links per platform, then read results in Gumroad Insights (breaks down visits/conversion by referrer):

Platform	Link
TikTok bio	worldgothicatlas.gumroad.com//upcnu?utm_source=tiktok&utm_medium=organic&utm_campaign=launch1
X posts	worldgothicatlas.gumroad.com//upcnu?utm_source=x&utm_medium=organic&utm_campaign=launch1

Pair this with each platform's own native analytics (TikTok: Analytics → traffic source, avg. watch time; X: Analytics → link clicks, impressions) to see which specific posts drove bio clicks.

Optional Future-Proofing: A Bridge Page

If real pixel-based retargeting is wanted later (e.g. once running paid TikTok Ads), install the pixel on a simple page you control (Carrd, GitHub Pages, etc.) that redirects to the Gumroad link — not on the Gumroad page itself. Standard TikTok Pixel base code for that bridge page's <head>:

```
<script>
!function (w, d, t) {
  w.TiktokAnalyticsObject=t;var ttq=w[t]=w[t]||[];ttq.methods=["page","track","identify","instances","debug","on","off","once","ready","alias","group","enableCookie","disableCookie"],ttq.setAndDefer=function(t,e){t[e]=function(){t.push([e].concat(Array.prototype.slice.call(arguments,0)))}};for(var i=0;i<ttq.methods.length;i++)ttq.setAndDefer(ttq,ttq.methods[i]);
  ttq.load=function(e,n){var i="https://analytics.tiktok.com/i18n/pixel/events.js";ttq._i=ttq._i||[],ttq._i[e]=[],ttq._i[e]._u=i,ttq._t=ttq._t||[],ttq._t[e]=+new Date,ttq._o=ttq._o||[],ttq._o[e]=n||{};var p=document.createElement("script");p.type="text/javascript",p.async=!0,p.src=i+"?sdkid="+e+"&lib="+t;var l=document.getElementsByTagName("script")[0];l.parentNode.insertBefore(p,l)};
  ttq.load('YOUR_PIXEL_ID');
  ttq.page();
}(window, document, 'ttq');
```

Get YOUR_PIXEL_ID from TikTok Ads Manager → Assets → Events → Web Events → Create Pixel. On the bridge page, fire `ttq.track('ClickButton')` right before redirecting the visitor to the Gumroad link.

6. 14-Day Promotion & Upload Schedule

Day	Upload / Drop	TikTok (18:00 UTC)	X — A (13:00 UTC)	X — B (00:00 UTC)
1 (Mon)	—	Before/after, piece 1	Launch thread + link	Repost thread, new hook
2 (Tue) DE	—	Cinematic pan, piece 2	EN + DE caption	Quote-tweet Day 1 thread
3 (Wed)	—	Lore snippet video	Poll: favorite realm	Community reply push
4 (Thu) JP	Drop Set 2 (3 imgs)	"A new realm has opened"	EN + JP announcement	Mockup post
5 (Fri) UK/US	—	Before/after, piece 4	UK/US folklore caption	Carousel: all pieces so far
6 (Sat)	—	Cinematic pan, piece 5	"Name this place" ask	Repost top performer
7 (Sun) JP	—	Recap: 6 realms, 1 week	JP recap caption	Engagement poll
8 (Mon)	—	Before/after, piece 6	Momentum thread	Community replies
9 (Tue) DE	Drop Set 3 (3 imgs)	Drop announcement	EN + DE announcement	Mockup post
10 (Wed)	—	Lore snippet, piece 7	Poll: favorite of Set 3	Quote-tweet reactions
11 (Thu) JP	—	Cinematic pan, piece 8	JP caption	Carousel: 9 pieces
12 (Fri) UK/US	—	Before/after, piece 9	UK/US wall-art angle	Repost top performer
13 (Sat)	Drop Set 4 (3 imgs)	"12 realms complete"	Full-collection thread	Mockup/gallery-wall post
14 (Sun)	—	Recap reel, all 12	JP+DE+EN combined recap	Direct CTA + link

Check-in: compare Gumroad Insights (UTM by platform) against which regional-caption days performed best — that tells you where to lean for weeks 3–4.

7. Next Moves — Collections 3 & 4

Each move targets one of the 4 promoted markets directly — by Move 4, every market has its own dedicated collection.

Move 3 — Gothic Germany & Scotland (targets DE + UK)

Real fairy-tale/gothic castles and misty highlands — material that speaks directly to your German and UK audience's own folklore. Suggested locations: Neuschwanstein Castle, the Black Forest, Eilean Donan Castle, the Quiraing (Isle of Skye).

Suggested title: “Gothic Europe — Castles & Highlands Collection”

Timing: Launch Week 7–8 (2 weeks after Move 2's promo cycle ends, using Weeks 5–6 for editing/prep).

Move 4 — Gothic America (targets US)

Closes the loop on all four promoted markets. Suggested locations: Appalachian fog-covered mountains, New England haunted lighthouses, Salem's old burying grounds, Louisiana's moss-draped bayous.

Suggested title: “Gothic America — Haunted Frontier Collection”

Timing: Launch Week 11–12 (Weeks 9–10 for editing/prep after Move 3's promo cycle).

Move	Collection	Market Focus	Timing
1	Gothic Cappadocia	Global / Turkey	Live now
2	Haunted Japan	Japan	Weeks 3–4
3	Gothic Europe (Castles & Highlands)	Germany + UK	Weeks 7–8
4	Gothic America (Haunted Frontier)	USA	Weeks 11–12